004-09 PROSTITUTION AND MUI-TSAI 卖淫与妹仔

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主 *The increased interest* in social welfare 社会福利 and *British reformers' stronger interest* in Hong Kong 谓 led to the revival 复兴；恢复 of debates 辩论；争论 about prostitution 卖淫；色情行业 and mui-tsai 妹仔（旧时香港等地的婢女制度） in the 1920s and 1930s.

Although the colonial government had been ordered (v.) by the Colonial Office to abolish (v.) licensed 领有执照的 prostitution in Hong Kong at the turn of the century, by the 1920s it had devised 设计；制定 a complex and extralegal (a.)不受法律约束的；法律管辖以外的 system of regulating (v.) prostitution, using the various *discretionary (a.)自由裁量的；酌情决定的 powers* of the governor to close down 关闭；停业 any brothel 妓院 that failed to comply with 遵守；服从 these regulations 法规；条例.

Example 1. 案例
discretionary

→ 来自discreet, 慎重。 dis-, 分开，散开。-creet, 区分，词源同crisis, critic, discern. 即区分好坏善恶的，慎重的。

英 /dɪˈskreʃənəri/ 美 /dɪˈskreʃəneri/ 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句

dis·cre·tion·ary *adj.* /dɪˈskreʃənəri/

[usually before noun] (*formal*) decided according to the judgement of a person in authority about what is necessary in each particular situation; not decided by rules自由决定的；酌情行事的；便宜行事的

• You may be eligible for a discretionary grant for your university course.读大学课程可能会有资格获得学校自行决定是否发放的助学金。

The secretary for Chinese affairs 谓 classified (v.)分类；归类 brothels into those dealing with 与.....打交道；服务 Europeans, Indians, and Chinese.
As in the 1800s, 主 the controls on prostitutes 后定说明 dealing with Europeans 系 were much stricter 更严格的.

The result was that /venereal disease 性病 was kept under control 被控制住了 among the European population **but much less so** 程度,情况则远非如此 in the Chinese population.

Example 2. 案例
much less so

much：大大地、...得多（表示程度）
less：较少地、不那么（表示比较）
so：如此、这样

much less so的字面意思是：“（控制得）远比这差得多”。
整句直译：结果是，性病在欧洲人口中得到了控制，但在中国人口中则远非如此。

例:

- The system worked well in theory, **but much less so** in practice.（这个系统在理论上运行良好，但在实践中则远非如此。）
- He was happy with the result, but his colleagues were **much less so**.（他对结果感到满意，但他的同事们则（满意得）少得多。）
- English is widely studied in the north, **but much less so** in the south.（英语在北方被广泛学习，但在南方则（被学习的程度）少得多。）

In the early 1920s, 30–40 percent of Chinese men were estimated to suffer (v.) from venereal diseases.

Example 3. 案例

The increased interest in social welfare and British reformers' stronger interest in Hong Kong led to the revival of debates about prostitution and mui-tsai in the 1920s. Although the colonial government had been ordered by the Colonial Office to abolish licensed prostitution in Hong Kong at the turn of the century, by the 1920s it had devised a complex and extralegal system of regulating prostitution, using the various discretionary powers of the governor to close down any brothel that failed to comply with these regulations.
The secretary for Chinese affairs classified brothels into those dealing with Europeans, Indians, and Chinese.
As in the 1800s, the controls on prostitutes dealing with Europeans were much stricter.
The result was that venereal disease was kept under control among the European population but much less so in the Chinese population.
In the early 1920s, 30–40 percent of Chinese men were estimated to suffer from venereal diseases.

20 世纪 20 年代和 30 年代, 人们对社会福利的日益关注以及英国改革者对香港的日益重视, 导致关于卖淫和妓女的辩论再次兴起。尽管殖民地政府在世纪之交就奉殖民地事务部之命废除香港的持牌卖淫, 但到了 20 世纪 20 年代, 它却制定了一套复杂且游离于法律之外的卖淫管制体系, 利用总督的各种自由裁量权关闭任何不遵守规定的妓院。中华事务局局长将妓院分为服务于欧洲人、印度人和中国人的三类。与 19 世纪一样, 对服务于欧洲人的妓女的管制更为严格。结果是, 性病在欧洲人群体中得到了有效控制, 但在中国人群体中却远未得到控制。据估计, 在 20 世纪 20 年代初期, 30%至40%的中国男性患有性病。

The pressure **to end (v.) licensed 获许可的；获准经营的 prostitution** 卖淫 came from three main sources: reformers in Britain, the League of Nations 国际联盟, and a group of local European women.

The latter 后者的 group included *Penelope Clementi*, wife of Governor Clementi; *Mrs. Wolfe*, wife of the inspector general 监察长；总督察 of police; *Mrs. Tratman*, wife of Secretary for Chinese Affairs D.W.Tratman; and *Bella Woolf Southorn*, wife of the colonial secretary, Wilfred Southorn.

Licensed brothels 妓院 were gradually closed down in Hong Kong from 1931 to 1935, with predictable 可预见的；意料之中的 results: ① more soliciting (v.)（卖淫）拉客；招揽;征求；恳求；招募 on the streets, ② higher incidence 发生率 of *venereal 性病的 disease* among European soldiers and sailors, ③ and an increased number of so-called sly (a.)狡猾的，秘密的；非法的 brothels **disguised 伪装；掩饰 as** *massage (n.v.)按摩，推拿 parlors* (客厅，会客室) 按摩院, saunas 桑拿浴室；蒸汽浴, and bathhouses 浴室；澡堂.

Example 4. 案例

massage

→ 来自法语masser,揉，捏，来自PIE*mag,揉，捏，词源同make,mass.引申词义按摩。

英 /ˈmæsɑːʒ/ 美 /məˈsɑːʒ/ 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句 百科

n. v.

mas·sage /ˈmæsɑːʒ/

[VN]

1. to rub and press a person's body with the hands to reduce pain in the muscles and joints按摩；推拿
   - He massaged the aching muscles in her feet.他给她按摩脚上疼痛的肌肉。
   (*figurative*)
   - to massage sb's ego *(= to make sb feel better, more confident, attractive, etc.)* 增强某人的自信心
2. to rub a substance into the skin, hair, etc.用...揉擦（皮肤、头发等）
   - Massage the cream into your skin.将护肤霜揉擦到皮肤上。
3. (*disapproving*) to change facts, figures, etc. in order to make them seem better than they really are美化（事实）；虚报（数量）；粉饰
   - The government was accused of massaging the unemployment figures.政府被指责谎报了失业人数。

parlor = parlour

→ 这个词过去只是指“谈话的房间”。它是从法语词parler（谈话）派生来的。在中世纪拉丁语中，这样的房间叫作parla toriums，指的是寺院里的僧人在长时间的参禅打坐后同来访者交谈或僧人相互交谈的专用房间。Parlor现在除作“客厅”、“会客室”外，还可作“起居室”解。

英 / ˈpɑːlə(r) /　美 / ˈpɑːrlər /　全球发音

简明　牛津　新牛津　柯林斯　例句

par·lour *n.*　/ˈpɑːlə(r)/

(*BrE*) (*NAmE* **par·lor**)

1. (*old-fashioned*) a room in a private house for sitting in, entertaining visitors, etc. (私人住房的) 起居室，客厅

2. (in compounds构成复合词) (especially *NAmE*) a shop/store that provides particular goods or services (专营某种商品或业务的) 店铺
   - a beauty/an ice cream parlour美容院；冷食店

   ——see also funeral parlour , massage parlour

► Parlor (给客人用) 和 Living Room (自己家人用) 有区别么？

ChatGPT:
有区别，而且这个区别其实是一段社会历史留下的语言化石。

Header 1	Header 2
两百年前	**parlor**（或拼写为 **parlour**）是一个比较古老的词。它来自法语 **parler**，意思是“说话的地方”。在17—19世纪的英国家庭里，**parlor 是一个专门用来接待客人的房间**。它往往是家里布置得最体面的地方：好沙发、好地毯、钢琴、装饰画，全都放在那里。但有个微妙之处——**家人平时未必在那里生活**。 换句话说，parlor 有点像一个“社交舞台”。客人来访时才启用。很多维多利亚时代的房子甚至分成两种客厅： • **front parlor**：正式会客 • **back parlor**：家人日常使用 这种布局反映的是一种很讲究礼仪和阶级秩序的社会。
如今	到了20世纪初，美国社会结构开始变化： 城市化、房屋面积缩小、家庭结构更随意。于是出现了一个更生活化的词——**living room**。 **living room 的字面意思其实很直白：生活的房间。 它不是专门给客人的，而是家庭成员日常活动的中心：**聊天、看书、看电视、孩子玩耍、朋友来访都在这里。 于是两者的区别可以这样理解： parlor → **正式会客空间** living room → **日常生活空间** 再往深一点看，这个词的变化其实反映了一种文化转变： 从19世纪那种讲究礼仪和“体面展示”的家庭文化，转向20世纪更随意、更家庭化的生活方式。
历史的遗留	在美国，**parlor 这个词几乎消失了**，但它在某些行业里被保留下来，比如： • **beauty parlor**（美容院） • **ice-cream parlor**（冰淇淋店）

Header 1	Header 2
	• **funeral parlor**（殡仪馆接待室） 这些地方都有一个共同点：**接待客人的场所**。所以旧词被保留在了商业语境里。 而在现代住宅里，人们几乎只说 **living room**。 所以当你在历史书或老小说里看到 **parlor**，脑海里可以想象一个画面： 厚重窗帘、雕花家具、钢琴、客人端着茶杯端坐交谈——一个带着维多利亚时代气味的会客室。

The Japanese instituted 建立；设立；实行 a system of regulated 受监管的；规范的 and inspected 检查的；视察的 brothels when they took over in 1941, but these were closed down after the British returned in 1945.

Example 5. 案例

The pressure to end licensed prostitution came from three main sources: reformers in Britain, the League of Nations, and a group of local European women.
The latter group included Penelope Clementi, wife of Governor Clementi; Mrs. Wolfe, wife of the inspector general of police; Mrs. Tratman, wife of Secretary for Chinese Affairs D.W.Tratman; and Bella Woolf Southorn, wife of the colonial secretary, Wilfred Southorn.
Licensed brothels were gradually closed down in Hong Kong from 1931 to 1935, with predictable results: more soliciting on the streets, higher incidence of venereal disease among European soldiers and sailors, and an increased number of so-called sly brothels disguised as massage parlors, saunas, and bathhouses.
The Japanese instituted a system of regulated and inspected brothels when they took over in 1941, but these were closed down after the British returned in 1945.

结束合法卖淫的压力主要来自三个方面：英国的改革者、国际联盟以及一群当地的欧洲女性。后者包括总督克莱门蒂的妻子佩内洛普·克莱门蒂、警察总监的妻子沃尔夫夫人、中华事务局局长特拉特曼的妻子特拉特曼夫人以及殖民地大臣威尔弗雷德·索索恩的妻子贝拉·伍尔夫·索索恩。从1931年到1935年, 香港的合法妓院逐渐被关闭, 其后果可想而知：街头拉客现象增多, 欧洲士兵和水手的性病发病率上升, 以及伪装成按摩院、桑拿浴室和澡堂的所谓“黑店”数量增加。1941年日本接管香港后, 建立了一套规范和检查妓院的制度, 但这些制度在1945年英国返回后也被关闭。

The mui-tsai 妹仔 issue (n.) had drawn (v.) quite a bit of local publicity （媒体的）宣传；关注；公开报道 in 1917 during a legal case involving two mui-tsai who had allegedly 据说；据称 been kidnapped.

主 A British *member of Parliament* 国会议员 who happened to be passing through 路过；经过 town 谓 **took** the case **to** the Colonial Office, asking how slavery 奴隶制 could not only **be tolerated** (v.) but could even **be protected by law** in the British Empire.

The Colonial Office was terribly embarrassed and seemed unaware (a.)不知道的；未察觉的 that **the system had been discussed** (v.) back in the 1880s.

殖民部感到极为尴尬，而且似乎并不知道该制度在19世纪80年代就已经被讨论过了。

In August 1918, Governor May explained that /although slavery was illegal in Hong Kong, the mui-tsai system was not slavery /and was **so** prevalent **that** 主 almost every family that could afford a mui-tsai 谓 had at least one.

Because the Colonial Office agreed that /it could not interfere (v.) too much with local customs, it recommended 建议；推荐 that /the issue be allowed to drop 搁置；不再追究.

In 1921 the secretary of Chinese affairs reported that /half of all Chinese families in Hong Kong had mui-tsai.

Example 6. 案例

The mui-tsai issue had drawn quite a bit of local publicity in 1917 during a legal case involving two mui-tsai who had allegedly been kidnapped.
A British member of Parliament who happened to be passing through town took the case to the Colonial Office, asking how slavery could not only be tolerated but could even be protected by law in the British Empire.
The Colonial Office was terribly embarrassed and seemed unaware that the system had been discussed back in the 1880s.
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Because the Colonial Office agreed that it could not interfere too much with local customs, it recommended that the issue be allowed to drop.
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1917 年, 一起涉及两名据称被绑架的梅菜的案件引起了当地不少关注。一位恰巧路过香港的英国议员将此案提交给殖民地事务部, 质问为何在英帝国境内, 奴隶制不仅被容忍, 甚至还能得到法律保护。殖民地事务部对此感到非常尴尬, 似乎并不知晓早在 19 世纪 80 年代就有人讨论过这一制度。1918 年 8 月, 梅总督解释说, 虽然奴隶制在香港是非法的, 但梅菜制度并非奴隶制, 而且非常普遍, 几乎每个有能力养梅菜的家庭都至少养了一个。由于殖民地事务部也认为不宜过多干预当地习俗, 因此建议此事就此作罢。1921 年, 中华事务司司长报告称, 香港半数华人家庭都养有梅菜。

One of the most intense and protracted 拖延的；持久的 British colonial policy disputes (v.)争论；争端 in the interwar period, the anti-mui-tsai campaign 运动；活动 had three main differences from that in the 1880s.

It **focused (v.) more on** the system itself **/rather than** on the prostitution 卖淫 aspect.

This time, the campaign had help (n.) from all sorts of places: British women in Hong Kong, a small group of local Chinese, members of Parliament in Britain, religious leaders (including the archbishops 大主教 of York and Canterbury), and international 国际的 women’s groups.

And since the system had been banned (v.) in China after the 1911 revolution (although the ban had never been effectively enforced), no one in Hong Kong could claim that /it should be allowed **simply because** it was a Chinese tradition.

Example 7. 案例

One of the most intense and protracted British colonial policy disputes in the interwar period, the anti-mui-tsai campaign had three main differences from that in the 1880s.
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And since the system had been banned in China after the 1911 revolution (although the ban had never been effectively enforced), no one in Hong Kong could claim that it should be allowed simply because it was a Chinese tradition.

两次世界大战期间, 英国殖民政策中最激烈、持续时间最长的争端之一——反娼运动, 与 19 世纪 80 年代的娼妓运动有三大主要区别。首先, 它更关注娼妓制度本身, 而非娼妓行为。其次, 这次运动得到了各方支持：在港的英国女性、一小群当地华人、英国议会议员、宗教领袖（包括约克大主教和坎特伯雷大主教）以及国际妇女团体。此外, 由于娼妓制度在 1911 年革命后在中国已被取缔（尽管禁令从未得到有效执行）, 因此香港没有人能够仅仅因为娼妓是中国传统就主张其在香港合法存在。

A key mover 推动者；发起者 in the anti-mui-tsai campaign was Clara Haslewood, wife of a commander 指挥官；司令官 in the Royal Navy 英国皇家海军 stationed 驻扎；派驻 in Hong Kong.

After *a barrage (n.)接二连三的一大堆（质问或指责等）；大量;火力网；弹幕射击；（尤指）掩护炮火 of* critical letters to the press 新闻界；媒体 offended (v.) leaders of the Chinese community, Governor Stubbs asked the Admiralty（英国旧时）海军部 to transfer（使）转移，搬迁；调任 Haslewood’s husband.

Example 8. 案例
barrage

→ 发音释义：['bærɑːʒ] n. 拦河坝；火力网；弹幕vt.以密集火力攻击或阻止 结构分析：barrage = barr（棒、栏杆）+age（物品）→用来阻拦的物品→拦河坝、火力网 词源解释：barr←法语barre（棒、栏杆） 同源词：bar（棒、栏杆）；barrier（障碍物、屏障）

英 /ˈbærɑːʒ/ 美 /bəˈrɑːʒ/ 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句 百科

bar·rage *n.* /ˈbærɑːʒ/

1. [C,usually sing.]the continuous firing of a large number of guns in a particular direction, especially to protect soldiers while they are attacking or moving towards the enemy火力网；弹幕射击；（尤指）掩护炮火
2. [sing.]~ **(of sth)** a large number of sth, such as questions or comments, that are directed at sb very quickly, one after the other, often in an aggressive way接二连三的一大堆（质问或指责等）
   - a **barrage of questions/criticisms/complaints** 连珠炮似的问题/批评/抱怨
3. [C]a wall or barrier built across a river to store water, prevent a flood, etc.堰；水坝；拦河坝

► dam 和 barrage 有区别吗

在工程逻辑、水流控制方式, 以及建造目的上, 有非常显著的区别。
简单来说：**Dam 是为了“堵水/蓄水”，而 Barrage 是为了“分水/调控”。**

Dam (大坝)：重在“蓄”	Barrage (堰/拦截坝)：重在“调”
Dam 通常是一道高大的、永久性的屏障，横跨河流以拦截水流。 • 外观： 通常很高，形成一个巨大的水库 (Reservoir)。	Barrage 规模通常比 Dam 小，且布满了连续的闸门 (Gates)。 • 外观： **看起来像一排并列的闸门房，横跨在河流上，坝体高度较低。**

• 功能： **主要是为了蓄水。蓄起来的水可以用来发电 (Hydroelectricity)、城市供水或灌溉。** • 控制： 水流通常从顶部的溢洪道或底部的管道流出，平时大部分水是被堵在坝后的。 • 具体例子： 三峡大坝 (Three Gorges Dam)。	• 功能： **主要是为了调节水位。通过开启或关闭闸门，将水引导到侧面的运河或灌溉渠中。** • 控制： 它是高度可控的。当所有闸门打开时，河流几乎可以像没有障碍物一样流过。 • 具体例子： 尼罗河上的许多灌溉拦截堰。

But the two spent their retirement in Britain /rallying 召集；集结；呼吁；抗议 against the mui-tsai system by writing the press and members of Parliament.

Soon the Colonial Office was receiving complaints (n.) from groups such as *the Anti-Slavery and Aborigines 土著居民 Protection Society*, the Fabian Society, *the International Woman Suffrage (n.)选举权；投票；参政权 Alliance* , and *the League 联盟，同盟 of Nations Union* 国际联盟协会.

Example 9. 案例
Fabian Society

费边社：英国的一个社会主义团体，奉"行渐进主义"的思想，倡导和平宪政和市政社会主义的道路。

As the campaign **gained steam** (蒸汽,蒸汽动力) 壮大；增强势头 in Britain, *the Hong Kong Anti-Mui Tsai Society* was founded in 1921, its *organizing committee* 委员会 almost all Chinese.

Example 10. 案例
这里 its organizing committee almost all Chinese 似乎没有谓语或系动词?

► DeepSeek:

its organizing committee almost all Chinese （其组织委员会几乎全是中国人）确实是一个没有谓语动词的独立结构，这在英语语法中被称为 “独立主格结构” (Absolute Phrase)。

逻辑主语 (Nominative Absolute)：its organizing committee
逻辑表语 (Predicative)：almost all Chinese

语法本质：它省略了系动词 being。完整的写法应该是：
its organizing committee (being) almost all Chinese

为什么可以省略系动词？
在"独立主格结构"中，being通常可以省略，尤其是在表示“伴随状态”或“补充说明”时。

这个独立主格结构在句中充当 “伴随状语” ，用来补充说明主句主语 the Hong Kong Anti-Mui Tsai Society的细节。

又例:

- He stood there, *his hands (being) in his pockets*.（他站在那里，双手插在口袋里。）
- *The meeting over*, we all went home.（会议结束后，我们都回家了。）
- He entered the room, *his face (being) red with anger*.（他走进房间，脸气得通红。）

总结：这是一个典型的 “名词 + 形容词” 型独立主格结构，省略了系动词 being，用来描述主句动作发生时的伴随状态。

► Gemini:

"独立主格结构"中省略"系动词"（通常为 be 或 being）常见于“名词/代词 + 形容词/副词/介词短语”结构，用于描写伴随状态、原因或时间。这种省略使句子更紧凑，**逻辑主语与主句主语不一致，**

- All (being) ready, we set off. 一切准备就绪，我们出发了。
- He sat there, eyes (being) closed. 他坐在那里，闭着眼睛。

独立主格由“独立主语 + 非谓语动词/形容词/副词/名词/介词短语”构成。当谓语部分是"系表结构"（系动词+表语）时，系动词常被省略。

省略 be 或 being 的常见结构:

Header 1	Header 2
名词/代词 + 形容词	• *All (being) ready*, we started. (全准备好了，我们出发了。) • She stood there, *her face (being) red*. (她站在那，脸红了。)
名词/代词 + 介词短语	• The teacher came in, *a book (being) in her hand*. (老师走进来了，手里拿着书。) • He left, *his heart (being) at ease*. (他离开了，心很安宁。)
名词/代词 + 副词	• *The meeting (being) over*, we all went home. (会议结束了，我们都回家了。
with/without 引导的独立主格	当使用 with 或 without 引导时，同样可以省略 being。 • *With all work done* (= With all work having been done), he went home. 所有工作完成后 ，他回家了。 • She sat there *with her eyes closed* (= with her eyes being closed). 她闭着眼睛坐在那里

The two Chinese members of the Legislative Council 谓 responded (v.) by **establishing (v.)** ***the Society for the Protection of Mui Tsai*** to help (v.) regulate (v.) the system **instead of** ending it.

主 The Anti-Mui Tsai Society, which also received backing (n.)支持；赞助 from local groups such as the *Young Women’s Christian Association* 基督教女青年会, established in 1920, 谓 was able **to win over** 争取；说服 many of the labor unions 工会 /**and to gain**

(v.) support from the foreign community, especially since its English secretary 英文秘书, C.G.Anderson, **wrote regularly to** the newspapers in Hong Kong and Britain.

反妹仔协会（该协会还得到了当地团体的支持，如 1920 年成立的基督教女青年会），成功争取到了许多工会的支持，并获得了外国侨民团体的拥护，尤其是因为其英文秘书 C.G. 安德森定期给香港和英国的报纸撰稿。

But *the Society for the Protection of Mui Tsai* had the Tung Wah Hospital Committee, the District Watch Committee 地区监督委员会, and the Po Leung Kuk **on its side**.

Example 11. 案例

A key mover in the anti-mui-tsai campaign was Clara Haslewood, wife of a commander in the Royal Navy stationed in Hong Kong.
After a barrage of critical letters to the press offended leaders of the Chinese community, Governor Stubbs asked the Admiralty to transfer Haslewood’s husband.
But the two spent their retirement in Britain rallying against the mui-tsai system by writing the press and members of Parliament.
Soon the Colonial Office was receiving complaints from groups such as the Anti-Slavery and Aborigines Protection Society, the Fabian Society, the International Woman Suffrage Alliance, and the League of Nations Union.
As the campaign gained steam in Britain, the Hong Kong Anti-Mui Tsai Society was founded in 1921, its organizing committee almost all Chinese.
The two Chinese members of the Legislative Council responded by establishing the Society for the Protection of Mui Tsai to help regulate the system instead of ending it.
The Anti-Mui Tsai Society, which also received backing from local groups such as the Young Women’s Christian Association, established in 1920, was able to win over many of the labor unions and to gain support from the foreign community, especially since its English secretary, C.G.Anderson, wrote regularly to the newspapers in Hong Kong and Britain.
But the Society for the Protection of Mui Tsai had the Tung Wah Hospital Committee, the District Watch Committee, and the Po Leung Kuk on its side.

反梅傩运动的关键人物之一是克拉拉·哈斯伍德, 她是驻港皇家海军一位指挥官的妻子。她向报刊发表了一系列批评梅傩制度的信件, 激怒了华人社区的领袖, 以至于总督斯塔布斯要求海军部将哈斯伍德的丈夫调离香港。然而, 这对夫妇退休后留在英国, 继续通过写信给报刊和议员来反对梅傩制度。很快, 殖民地事务部就收到了来自反奴隶制和原住民保护协会、费边社、国际妇女参政联盟以及国际联盟等团体的投诉。随着这场运动在英国愈演愈烈, 香港反梅傩协会于 1921 年成立, 其组织委员会几乎全部由华人组成。立法会的两位华人议员则成立了保梅傩协会, 旨在规范梅傩制度, 而不是废除它。反梅娼会也得到了包括基督教女青年会（成立于 1920 年）在内的本地团体的支持, 成功争取到了许多工会的支持, 并获得了海外社群的支持, 尤其得益于其英文秘书 CG Anderson 定期向香港和英国的报纸投稿。但护梅娼会则得到了东华医院委员会、区监察委员会和保良局的支持。

In February 1922, *Secretary for the Colonies* Winston Churchill, who had previously defended (v.) the system, argued to *the House of Commons* 英国下议院 that /the system should be abolished.

Although Governor Stubbs argued that /the timing 时机；时间选择 was bad —the colony **was still recovering** from the seamen’s strike —and the Chinese bourgeoisie 资产阶级 opposed (v.)反对；抵制 abolishing the system, Churchill promised *the House of Commons* that /the system would be ended within a year.

The leaders of the Chinese community insisted that /the system benefited (v.) the girls and their parents /and prevented infanticide 杀婴；杀婴行为, and Stubbs 人名 **warned**

the Colonial Office **that** /主 interfering (v.) too much in local customs 谓 might even turn (v.) the Chinese against their British rulers.

Still, the Female *Domestic Service* 家政服务 Ordinance 法令；条例；法规 was passed in 1923, although Stubbs **distanced （使）远离，疏远 himself from** 使疏远；使脱离 the ordinance by insisting that /the well-meaning 好心的；善意的 reformers in Britain simply did not understand the system or Chinese customs.

(As in the late 1800s, there was no *single Chinese view* 观点，看法 toward the practice 做法；惯例；习俗, but the colonial government **dismissed 不予考虑；摒弃 to** the British government **as** not representative 代表的；典型的 the Chinese who opposed the mui-tsai system.)

（就像在19世纪晚期那样，对于这种做法，中国人并没有统一的看法，但殖民政府却向英国政府宣称，那些反对“妹仔”制度的中国人的意见么不具代表性。）

Example 12. 案例

► ChatGPT:

谓语动词是 dismissed，宾语是： the Chinese who opposed the mui-tsai system

这句话的核心动词是 dismiss。在标准语序中，我们通常说：
dismiss + [宾语] + as + [补语] (认为某人/某事不具代表性而予以驳回)
dismiss someone as + 评价

- The claim **was dismissed as** unrealistic. 他的说法被认为是不现实的。

原文的结构是：
dismissed (动词) + to the British government (状语，指对象) + as not representative (宾语补足语) + the Chinese who opposed the mui-tsai system (真正的长宾语)。

当你遇到 dismissed ... as ... [长名词/从句] 这种结构时，可以把它理解为：
把 [最后的长名词] 看作是 [as 后面描述的样子] 告诉 [to 后面的人]。

dismiss

英 /dɪsˈmɪs/ 美 /dɪsˈmɪs/ 全球发音

简明 牛津 新牛津 韦氏 柯林斯 例句 百科

dis·miss v. /dɪsˈmɪs/

[VN]

1. ~ sb/sth (as sth) to decide that sb/sth is not important and not worth thinking or talking about不予考虑；摒弃；对...不屑一提

   SYN wave aside

   - I think we can safely dismiss their objections.我认为我们对他们的异议完全可以不予理会。
   - Vegetarians are no longer dismissed as cranks.素食主义者不再被当作怪人。
   - He dismissed the opinion polls as worthless.他认为民意测验毫无用处而不予考虑。
   - The suggestion should not be **dismissed out of hand** *(= without thinking about it)* .这建议不应当直接就被摒弃。

2. ~ sth (from sth) to put thoughts or feelings out of your mind去除，消除，摒除（思想、感情等）
   - Dismissing her fears, she climbed higher.她排除了恐惧，爬得更高了。
   - He dismissed her from his mind.他挥去了对她的思念。

3. ~ sb (from sth) to officially remove sb from their job解雇；免职；开除

   SYN fire , sack

   - She claims she was unfairly dismissed from her post.她声称自己被无理免职。

4. to send sb away or allow them to leave让（某人）离开；把（某人）打发走；解散
   - At 12 o'clock the class was dismissed.12点下课了。

5. (law 律)to say that a trial or legal case should not continue, usually because there is not enough evidence驳回；不受理
   - The case was dismissed.此案已被驳回。

6. (in **cricket**板球) to end the **innings** of a player or team（使击球员或球队）出局

以上来源于: 牛津词典

And the bill 法案；议案 **ended up** doing very little, except mainly to prohibit (v.) any new mui-tsai transactions 交易；买卖 and domestic service 家务服务；家政服务 for girls under ten years of age.

最终，这项法案几乎没起到什么作用，只是主要禁止了任何新的“妹仔”交易, 以及十岁以下女孩从事家庭服务。

But after Stubbs **reported** in 1924 **that** /no new mui-tsai had been engaged 雇用；聘用 /**and that** the number of mui-tsai **had dropped (v.) considerably** 非常；大大地；显著地, the Colonial Office **let the issue go** 让问题过去吧.

但在Stubbs 于1924年报告称, 没有新的妹仔被雇佣，且妹仔的数量已大幅减少后，殖民部便不再追究此事了。

Although reports in the mid-1930s suggested that /the number of mui-tsai had probably increased after 1923, the bill temporarily ended (v.) all agitation 骚动；煽动；抗议活动 in Britain.

Example 13. 案例

In February 1922, Secretary for the Colonies Winston Churchill, who had previously defended the system, argued to the House of Commons that the system should be abolished.
Although Governor Stubbs argued that the timing was bad—the colony was still recovering from the seamen’s strike—and the Chinese bourgeoisie opposed abolishing the system, Churchill promised the House of Commons that the system would be ended within a year.
The leaders of the Chinese community insisted that the system benefited the girls and their parents and prevented infanticide, and Stubbs warned the Colonial Office that interfering too much in local customs might even turn the Chinese against their British rulers.
Still, the Female Domestic Service Ordinance was passed in 1923, although Stubbs distanced himself from the ordinance by insisting that the well-meaning reformers in Britain simply did not understand the system or Chinese customs.
(As in the late 1800s, there was no single Chinese view toward the practice, but the colonial government dismissed to the British government as not representative the Chinese who opposed the mui-tsai system.) And the bill ended up doing very little, except mainly to prohibit any new mui-tsai transactions and domestic service for girls under ten years of age.
But after Stubbs reported in 1924 that no new mui-tsai had been engaged and that the number of mui-tsai had dropped considerably, the Colonial Office let the issue go.
Although reports in the mid-1930s suggested that the number of mui-tsai had probably increased after 1923, the bill temporarily ended all agitation in Britain.

1922 年 2 月, 曾为该制度辩护的殖民地事务大臣温斯顿·丘吉尔在下议院提出废除该制度的动议。尽管总督斯塔布斯认为时机不佳——殖民地仍在从海员罢工中恢复——而且华人资产阶级也反对废除该制度, 丘吉尔仍向下议院承诺一年内废除该制度。华人社区领袖坚持认为该制度有利于女孩及其父母, 并能防止杀婴, 斯塔布斯警告殖民地事务部, 过度干预当地习俗甚至可能使华人反抗英国统治者。尽管如此, 《女佣家政服务条例》还是在 1923 年获得通过, 但斯塔布斯却与该条例划清界限, 坚称英国那些好心的改革者根本不了解该制度或中国习俗。（如同 19 世纪末一样, 华人对这种做法并没有统一的看法, 但殖民政府却以华人反对 “卖身契” 制度不具代表性为由, 拒绝向英国政府提出异议。）最终, 这项法案收效甚微, 主要内容是禁止任何新的 “卖身契” 交易以及为十岁以下女孩提供家政服务。但 1924 年, 斯塔布斯报告称, 没有新增 “卖身契”的案例, 而且 “卖身契” 的数量也大幅下降, 殖民地事务部便不再追究此事。尽管 20 世纪 30 年代中期的报道显示, “卖身契” 的数量在 1923 年后可能有所增加, 但这项法案暂时平息了英国国内的所有抗议活动。

The mui-tsai issue reemerged 再次出现；重新浮现, however, after the Canton government abolished all forms of slavery in March 1927 /and canceled the deeds 契约；证书 for the transfer 转移；转让 of mui-tsai.

In October 1928, the newly revived (a.)复兴；恢复 Anti-Mui Tsai Society declared that /conditions had become even worse since 1923 /and sent (v.) details to groups in Britain.

When the secretary of *the Anti-Slavery and Aborigines 土著；原住民 Protection Society* learned about the situation, he wrote a letter to the liberal 自由主义的 *Manchester Guardian* (监护人；守卫者)曼彻斯特卫报 that was soon published in a widely circulated 流传；传播 pamphlet 小册子；手册.

当"反奴隶制与原住民保护协会"的秘书了解到这一情况后，他给自由派的《曼彻斯特卫报》写了一封信，这封信很快就被刊登在一本发行量很大的小册子上。

The Colonial Office was **in a spot** 处于困境；处境尴尬: it had failed to fulfill 履行；实现 Churchill’s promise to Parliament, and now the new governor, Clementi, was defending the system.

Clementi **argued that** /there was no evidence that the number of mui-tsai had increased /**and that** the system could not **be abolished any faster** 无法以更快的速度废除 /without alienating (v.)使疏远；使不友好 the Chinese population, especially *as long as* 只要 the system continued to exist (v.) in China, where 主 *the laws against it* 谓 were not being enforced 实施；执行.

克莱门蒂辩称，没有证据表明妹仔（mui-tsai，指旧中国被贩卖、役使的婢女）的数量有所增加，而且如果不疏远华人社群，这一制度就无法以更快的速度废除；尤其是只要该制度在中国大陆继续存在的话，而中国大陆中相关的反制法律还并未得到执行。

Convinced that /reforming or abolishing the system would be more harmful than useful, Clementi may have been right: 主 the number of abandoned (a.) dead babies and children 系 was 1,851 in 1929, some 大约 300 **more than** in 1928 /and about 700 **more than** in 1927.

克莱门蒂认为，改革或废除这一制度的弊大于利，他或许是对的：1929年被遗弃的死婴和儿童数量为1851名，比1928年多出约300名，比1927年多出约700名。

Example 14. 案例

这里some 300 , about 700 中的 some 和 about 怎么理解?

这里的 some 和 about 都表示 “大约” 或 “约” ，用于修饰数字，表示这是一个 近似值 或 估计值，而非精确统计。

Example 15. 案例

The mui-tsai issue reemerged, however, after the Canton government abolished all forms of slavery in March 1927 and canceled the deeds for the transfer of mui-tsai.
In October 1928, the newly revived Anti-Mui Tsai Society declared that conditions had become even worse since 1923 and sent details to groups in Britain.
When the secretary of the Anti-Slavery and Aborigines Protection Society learned about the situation, he wrote a letter to the liberal Manchester Guardian that was soon published in a widely circulated pamphlet.
The Colonial Office was in a spot: it had failed to fulfill Churchill’s promise to Parliament, and now the new governor, Clementi, was defending the system.
Clementi argued that there was no evidence that the number of mui-tsai had increased and that the system could not be abolished any faster without alienating the Chinese population, especially as long as the system continued to exist in China, where the laws against it were not being enforced.
Convinced that reforming or abolishing the system would be more harmful than useful, Clementi may have been right: the number of abandoned dead babies and children was 1,851 in 1929, some 300 more than in 1928 and about 700 more than in 1927.

然而, 1927 年 3 月广州政府废除一切形式的奴隶制并取消了奴役契约后, 奴役问题再次浮出水面。1928 年 10 月, 新近复兴的反奴役协会宣称, 自 1923 年以来, 奴役状况甚至更加恶化, 并将详情发送给了英国的团体。反奴隶制和原住民保护协会的秘书得知此事后, 致信自由派报纸《曼彻斯特卫报》，该信很快被印成小册子广泛传播。殖民地事务部陷入困境：它未能兑现丘吉尔对议会的承诺, 而新任总督克莱门蒂却在为奴役制度辩护。克莱门蒂辩称, 没有证据表明奴役人数有所增加, 而且如果不疏远华人, 就无法更快地废除奴役制度, 尤其是在中国, 由于相关法律并未得到执行, 奴役制度仍然存在。克莱门蒂确信改革或废除该制度弊大于利, 他的看法或许是对的：1929 年被遗弃的死婴和死儿童的数量为 1851 人, 比 1928 年增加了约 300 人, 比 1927 年增加了约 700 人。

主 Many of the Britons 英国人；不列颠人 who had been involved in the campaign in the early 1920s 谓 now resurfaced (v.)重新出现；再度露面, distributing (v.)分发；散布 articles

with such inflammatory 煽动性的；激起愤怒的 titles as “Little Yellow Slaves under *the Union Jack* 英国国旗.”

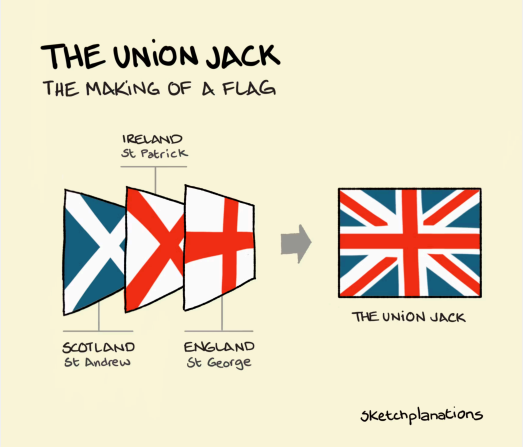
Example 16. 案例

Union Jack

在帆船时代，**船头有一根短桅杆，专门用来悬挂代表国家主权的旗帜，这根桅杆被称为 Jack staff (船首旗竿；舰首旗竿)。**
在这根桅杆上悬挂的小旗，就被称为 Jack（舰首旗）。

Union（联合）指的是英格兰、苏格兰（后来加入爱尔兰）的旗帜合并。
所以，挂在船头的这面“联合旗”，就自然而然地被称为 Union Jack。

你可以把 Jack 想象成某种“小型的、起标识作用的工具”。
在英语里，Jack 经常指代小东西：比如 Jack (千斤顶)、Jack-o'-lantern (南瓜灯)。
在旗帜语境下，它就是特指那面“挂在船头的小型主权旗”。



As historian Susan Pedersen argues, the issue was “**not only** about the definition of ‘slavery,’ **but also** about the wider character 性质；特征 and the obligations 责任；义务 of British rule.”

Part of *a maternalist 母性主义者,母性主义的 trend* in *Britain* and *throughout the British Empire*, the campaign showed /how British women were beginning **to play an activist (a.)积极分子的；激进主义的 role** in the expansion of social services in their empire.

作为英国及整个大英帝国的母性主义潮流的一部分，这场运动展现了 英国女性如何开始在其帝国的社会服务扩张中, 扮演积极分子的角色。

But there was also *more than a hint 少量；迹象 of* 远超一丝迹象,相当明显的,不言而喻的 racism 种族主义, for many of the British reformers were convinced (a.)确信的；信服的 that /only British women, not any Chinese groups, could care for 照顾；照料 the freed 被解放的 mui-tsai.

Example 17. 案例

Many of the Britons who had been involved in the campaign in the early 1920s now resurfaced, distributing articles with such inflammatory titles as “Little Yellow Slaves under the Union Jack.” As historian Susan Pedersen argues, the issue was “not only about the definition of ‘slavery,’ but also about the wider character and the obligations of British rule.” 27 Part of a maternalist trend in Britain and throughout the British Empire, the campaign showed how British women were beginning to play an activist role in the expansion of social services in their empire.

But there was also more than a hint of racism, for many of the British reformers were convinced that only British women, not any Chinese groups, could care for the freed mui-tsai.

许多曾在 20 世纪 20 年代初参与这场运动的英国人如今再次出现, 散发着诸如《英国国旗下的小黄奴》等煽动性标题的文章。正如历史学家苏珊·佩德森所言, 这个问题“不仅关乎‘奴隶制’的定义, 还关乎英国统治的更广泛的性质和义务”。 27 作为英国乃至整个大英帝国母性主义思潮的一部分, 这场运动表明英国女性开始在帝国社会服务的扩展中发挥积极作用。但其中也隐隐透露出种族主义的意味, 因为许多英国改革者坚信, 只有英国女性, 而非任何华人团体, 才有资格照顾获释的梅菜。

In response to 作为回应 so much pressure, in 1929 the Legislative Council passed (v.) an amendment 修正案；修订案 **stipulating 规定；明确要求 that** mui-tsai were to be registered (v.) and paid (v.) wages.

Example 18. 案例
mui-tsai were to be registered

这里的 were to be registered是一个 **“be + to do” 结构，在这里表示 “法律或规定要求必须做某事”，相当于中文的 “须”、“应” 或 “必须”。**

是不定式的被动形式，通常表示将来时间，指某个"被动动作", 在未来将被完成，常用于描述计划、安排或预期。它强调动作的**“被动性”和“将来性”**，即**“待办”、“即将被做”**。

- There is much work **to be done**. (有许多工作要做)。

本句这种结构, 在描述法律、规章或正式指令时，**表示 “被规定/被要求去做” 或 “未来的安排/计划”**。
这里的 were to be强调了 “法律强制力” 和 “未来的义务”。它不是简单的“将要被登记”，而是 “根据法律，她们**有义务**被登记”。

be to do (were to be registered) ：带有 “指令性” 或 “计划性”，强调这是修正案 “规定” 的内容，是必须遵守的条款。
在翻译时，为了体现这种 “法律强制” 的语气，建议使用 “须”、“应” 或 “必须” 等词：

Although registration eventually increased (v.) /and the Colonial Office was generally satisfied, the 1929 amendments 修正案 did not please (v.) everyone.

Legislative Council member Tso Seen Wan argued that /far from 远非,远离,远远不是 being a slave, a mui-tsai **was treated as** a foster (a.)收养的；寄养的 daughter.

As such 因此；就这点而言；照此, she might be asked (v.) **to “do such service** 后定说明 as 像…那样的 主 a natural 亲生的,天然的，非人为的 daughter 谓 might **be called upon 被要求；被号召(做某事) to** at any time.”

因此，她可能会被要求“履行亲生女儿在任何时候都可能被要求履行的那种义务。

Example 19. 案例
such … as … 引导定语从句

- I have **such** a bag **as** you bought yesterday. 我有一个和你昨天买的一样的包。
- He gave **such** an answer **as** surprised everyone. 他给出了一个让所有人吃惊的回答。

might **be called upon** to at any time.

这里其实有 不定式省略：to (do)
完整形式：…might **be called upon** to do (v.) at any time.

前面已经出现动词 do，后面为避免重复，只保留 to。

例:
I want to go /but I don’ t dare to.
= I don’ t dare to go.
我想去但不敢去。

be called upon to do sth ：被要求 / 被号召做某事

- Citizens **are called upon** to protect the environment. 公民被要求保护环境。

Many Chinese **resented (v.)愤恨；不满；憎恶 the amendment** for stigmatizing (v.)侮辱；使蒙受耻辱；诋毁 *having a mui-tsai*.

许多中国人对这项修正案心怀不满，因为它将拥有"妹仔"的行为视为耻辱。

Example 20. 案例
stigmatize

[VN][usually passive] (formal) to treat sb in a way that makes them feel that they are very bad or unimportant 使感到羞耻；侮蔑

→ 来自希腊语 stigmatos,所有格形式于 stigma,烙印，刺痕标记，-ize,使。引申词义打上耻辱标记，使受耻辱等。
来自拉丁语 stigma,烙印，伤痕，来自希腊语 stigma,烙印，刺痕标记，来自 stizein,作标记， 刺青，来自 PIE*steig,刺，词源同 stick,sting.引申词义耻辱标记，耻辱，羞耻等。

The Anti-Mui Tsai Society claimed that /fewer than half of the mui-tsai were actually registered.

After more pressure from societies in Britain, in July 1931 the government added (v.) a police inspector 检查员；督察；巡官 and two Chinese female inspectors to help register (v.) mui-tsai.

Finally, **in response to** *increased (a.) pressure in Britain* and *a colonial inquiry* 调查；探究 (the Woods Commission) 后定说明 prompted 促使；导致；引起 by *the League of Nations 国际联盟 Permanent Advisory 咨询的；顾问的 Committee of Experts 专家 on Slavery*, in April 1938 /主 the Legislative Council 谓 **passed (v.) legislation** 法律；法规 making it compulsory (a.)强制的；义务的；必须做的 to register (v.) all adopted 被收养的 girls with the secretary for Chinese affairs.

最后，迫于英国国内日益增长的压力，以及在"国际联盟"常设"奴隶制问题专家咨询委员会"的推动下开展的一项殖民调查（伍兹委员会），立法局于1938年4月通过了一项法案，规定所有被收养的女孩, 都必须向华人事务秘书登记。

However, this affected (v.) only girls who were actually registered (of which there were still more than one thousand) and did little to end (v.) the large number of girls being sold into prostitution.

The mui-tsai system lasted (v.) beyond the end of World War II, 伴随状 with cases **being reported** even into the 1970s.

mui-tsni制度 一直延续到第二次世界大战结束之后，甚至在20世纪70年代, 仍有相关案例被报道。

Example 21. 案例

with cases being reported even into the 1970s.

伴随状语（with 复合结构）
逻辑主语：cases
逻辑谓语：being reported（现在分词被动式）

Example 22. 案例

In response to so much pressure, in 1929 the Legislative Council passed an amendment stipulating that mui-tsai were to be registered and paid wages.
Although registration eventually increased and the Colonial Office was generally satisfied, the 1929 amendments did not please everyone.
Legislative Council member Tso Seen Wan argued that far from being a slave, a mui-tsai was treated as a foster daughter.
As such, she might be asked to "do such service as a natural daughter might be called upon to at any time." 28 Many Chinese resented the amendment for stigmatizing having a mui-tsai.
The Anti-Mui Tsai Society claimed that fewer than half of the mui-tsai were actually registered.
After more pressure from societies in Britain, in July 1931 the government added a police inspector and two Chinese female inspectors to help register mui-tsai.
Finally, in response to increased pressure in Britain and a colonial inquiry (the Woods Commission) prompted by the League of Nations' Permanent Advisory Committee of Experts on Slavery, in April 1938 the Legislative Council passed legislation making it compulsory to register all adopted girls with the secretary for Chinese affairs.
However, this affected only girls who were actually registered (of which there were still more than one thousand) and did little to end the large number of girls being sold into prostitution.
The mui-tsni system lasted beyond the end of World War II, with cases being reported even into the 1970s.

迫于各方压力, 立法会于 1929 年通过一项修正案, 规定女佣必须登记并领取工资。尽管登记人数最终有所增加, 殖民地事务部也基本满意, 但 1929 年的修正案并非人人赞同。立法会议员曹善婉认为, 女佣并非奴隶, 而是被视为养女。因此, 她随时可能被要求"像亲生女儿一样服侍他人"。 28 许多华人对此修正案感到不满, 认为它给拥有女佣的行为蒙上了污名。 反女佣协会声称, 实际登记的女佣不足一半。在英国各社团的进一步施压下, 政府于 1931 年 7 月增派一名警督和两名华裔女督察, 协助女佣登记工作。 最终, 在英国日益增长的压力以及国际联盟奴隶制问题常设专家咨询委员会促成的殖民地调查（伍兹委员会）的推动下, 立法会于 1938 年 4 月通过立法, 强制所有被收养的女孩在中华事务局局长处登记。然而, 这项立法仅对实际登记的女孩有效（当时仍有超过一千名女孩）, 对阻止大量女孩被贩卖卖淫几乎毫无作用。 "卖淫嫖娼" 制度一直延续到二战结束之后, 甚至在 20 世纪 70 年代仍有相关案例报道。